

DAVID ZADDACH

Product & Technology Executive | Music Tech | Platforms, AI & Digital Transformation

Berlin, Germany • david.zaddach@gmail.com • +49 176 34640687 • linkedin.com/in/david-zaddach

PROFILE

Product and technology executive combining deep music-industry expertise with leadership of complex digital platforms and international product organizations. Currently lead BMG’s Technology Product organization, with responsibility for 50+ products across rights, royalties, digital supply chain, licensing and customer-facing music platforms, and approximately €17m in annual technology investment. Career spans the intersection of music and technology - from music production, digital content and distribution to copyright and licensing platforms and, today, enterprise-scale product leadership. Led major platform transformations from monolithic legacy systems to cloud-native microservices and event-driven architectures while building product organizations, governance models and modern AI-enabled product practices.

CORE EXPERTISE

Product Leadership	Music Technology	Portfolio Strategy	AI Enablement	Rights & Royalties	Digital Supply Chain
Cloud & Microservices	APIs & Headless	Architecture Governance	Vendor Management	Technology Investment	Licensing & Sync

EXPERIENCE

BMG - The New Music Company | Berlin

Jul 2023 - Present

Senior Director Technology Products / Head of Product

Lead BMG’s Technology Product organization and a portfolio of 50+ products and applications spanning rights, royalties, digital supply chain, licensing, finance, client services, marketing and corporate functions, including customer-facing platforms such as myBMG, BMG Production Music and BMG Sync Plus.

- **Product & Portfolio Leadership:** Lead an international product organization with 5 direct reports and ~10 extended/external team members across Europe, the US, Middle East and India. Oversee ~€17m in annual technology investment, strategic technology vendors and external development partners.
- **Rights & Royalty Transformation:** Led the transformation of BMG’s copyright and royalty technology landscape away from monolithic, vendor-dependent systems toward a cloud-native microservices architecture, enabling faster development, independent deployments, continuous delivery, parallel royalty processing and greater scalability.
- **Event-Driven Platforms:** Led the introduction of Pub/Sub-based asynchronous integration across the microservices landscape, replacing legacy message-queue patterns and improving reliability and independence between domain applications.
- **Architecture & API Strategy:** Co-founded BMG’s Architecture Board with Cloud and Data leadership and oversee adoption of headless architecture principles across the Product portfolio, including AI-ready APIs for downstream products, business users and emerging agentic use cases.
- **AI Enablement:** Lead adoption of generative AI within Product, embedding AI into discovery, analysis and prototyping and introducing reusable skills and agentic workflows, while partnering with Engineering on AI-assisted development, code review and delivery standards.
- **Digital Experience Modernization:** Oversaw the transition of BMG’s web and content ecosystem from Magnolia to a reusable Contentful-based headless platform, alongside portfolio oversight for the 2026 launch of BMG Sync Plus.
- **Product Organization & Governance:** Built and developed Product as a dedicated function within Technology and established a portfolio prioritization framework, company-wide Product Days and quarterly product reviews to strengthen investment discipline, transparency and product culture.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE — CONTINUED

BMG - The New Music Company | Berlin

Jan 2023 - Jul 2023

Director Business Services

Expanded responsibility for strategic vendor management, commercial negotiations and technology contracts while continuing to lead the iMaestro transformation and Business Services product portfolio.

BMG - The New Music Company | Berlin

May 2022 - Dec 2022

Senior Product Owner Business Services

Joined BMG with a mandate to lead the decommissioning and modernization of iMaestro, BMG's legacy monolithic copyright and royalty platform, transitioning critical capabilities toward a modular, cloud-native product landscape.

ICE - International Copyright Enterprise / ICE Services GmbH

Oct 2015 - Apr 2022

Product & Product Ownership Roles

Senior Product Owner (2020-2022) • Product Owner (2018-2020) • Business Analyst (2016-2017) • Senior Product Manager, Online Operations (2015-2016)

- **Product Ownership:** Owned roadmap, backlog and delivery for an import platform and a licensing platform, working with two cross-functional Scrum teams consisting primarily of external developers.
- **Rights & Licensing Technology:** Translated complex copyright, licensing and operational requirements into scalable product capabilities for collecting societies and music publishers.
- **Stakeholder Management:** Aligned priorities across business, technology, customers and shareholders in a complex international multi-stakeholder environment.

freenet digital / Jesta Digital / Fox Mobile Distribution / Jamba | Berlin

2008 - 2015

Product Management, Content Operations & Team Leadership

Progressed from music content operations and team leadership into Product Management, combining digital music, technology, partner integration and product development.

- **Music, Content & Platforms:** Managed digital content and metadata across music, audio, visual and video products, including ingestion, licensing, APIs/frontends and internal content-management tools.
- **Product & Technology:** Worked as Product Owner and Scrum Master within cross-functional development, shaping product direction and technical roadmaps before moving into Product Management for mobile products.
- **Leadership & Partner Delivery:** Led a team of up to seven people and coordinated international launches across Engineering, QA, labels, distributors, external partners and service providers.

MUSIC & CREATIVE BACKGROUND

Music Producer & Engineer | 2000-Present Music production, recording and artist projects with a focus on hip-hop music.

24-7 Records - Co-Founder | 2003-2005 Co-founded and managed an independent music label.

Universal Music, Berlin | Product Coordination / Operations | 2007-2008

EDUCATION & ADDITIONAL

Magister Artium (Master's equivalent), Technische Universität Berlin

Musicology · Economics · Communication Science

Master's thesis: Censorship, art & economics in popular music - grade 1.0

Additional: Bertelsmann IT Circle Program | 2024-2026 · International Music Publishing Summer School | 2020 · ITIL® Foundation Certificate in IT Service Management

German (native) · English (fluent)